

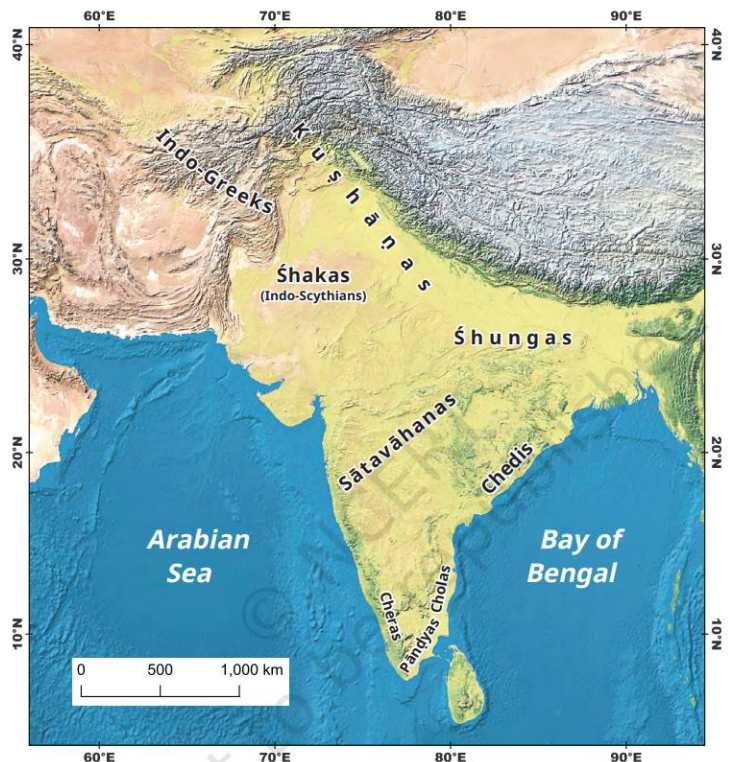
Chapter – 6: The Age of Reorganization

By continuous living tradition and a vital power of rejuvenescence, this land has readjusted itself through unnumbered transformations. – Jagdish Chandra Bose (1917)

- Bhavisha, Dhruv – recovered – previous journey – itching – another adventure
- Decide – use Itihasa – landed – new historical period
- Came across – collection – art pieces – each one – diff. from other
- They thought – these artifacts – belong to multiple kingdoms
- Very little known – Ashoka's successor – generally accepted – last Maurya emperor – assassinated – 185 BCE – commander-in-chief – Pushyamitra Shunga
- New kingdoms emerged – subcontinent – early tributary kingdoms – under ownership – Maurya empire
- Northwest region – weak – exposed to invasions – from outside
- This period – also known – age of reorganization existing regions – reorganized – new kingdoms
- Map of India – changed significantly – this age
- New kingdoms – competed – territorial control
- Peaceful methods – matrimonial alliances – OR – use of force – means – gaining control
- Constant wrestling – control over borders – imp. – keep safe
- Together with politics – burst – art, architecture, literature

Prominent dynasties

- Dynasties within –
 - Shungas, Chedis, Satavahanas, Cholas, Cheras, Pandyas
- Dynasties from outside –
 - Indo-Greeks, Shakas, Kushanas



Surge of the Shungas

- Pushyamitra Shunga – founded – Shunga dynasty – ruled over – north, central India
- Performed *Ashvamedha yajna* – Vedic ritual – establish himself – most powerful ruler
- His empire – smaller – previous Maurya Empire – BUT – kept safe – potential invaders – maintain relations – Greeks
- Cent. later – empire gone – did not last long
- This period – witnessed revival – Vedic rituals, practices – BUT – other schools of thoughts – continued to flourish
- Sanskrit – emerged – preferred lang. – philosophical literary works
- This period – *yoga sutras* – compiled by Patanjali
- Shungas – patronized – literature, art, architecture
- Bharhut Stupa – Madhya Pradesh – beautiful examples – Shunga art

- Built – time of Ashoka – Shungas – added – carved railings, reliefs – depicting – Buddha's life
- These – earliest examples – Buddhist art

Shunga Contribution to Art

- Figurines – depicting Greeks, women, child, hair ornaments, etc.
- Bronze, ivory, beads – ornaments

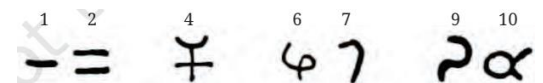
The Satavahanas

- Limited evidence – seems – Shunga – at war – many neighbouring kingdoms
- May include – Satavahanas – ruled large parts – Deccan – 2nd Cent. BCE onward – south – Shunga empire
- Sometimes – referred – Andhras – Satavahanas – powerful dynasty – empire – comprised – Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Maharashtra – diff. cities – diff. times – most famous – Amravati, Pratishthana
- Trade, commerce – flourished – Satavahana kingdom
- Coins – issued – Satavahana rulers – found – various regions – Gujarat to Andhra Pradesh – western, eastern coasts
- Many coins – depicted – ships – suggest – maritime trade – imp. part – economic life
- Type of ship – adjoining coin – suggest – advance shipbuilding, navigation tech.
- Agriculture – flourished – Krishna-Godavari River sys. – economic stability – kingdom
- Satavahanas – active trade networks – reaching – Roman empire – included – exchange of goods – spices, textiles, sandalwood, luxury items – gold-plated pearls, ivory, etc.
- Tolls, taxes – added revenue – kingdom
- Economic prosperity, peaceful political period – facilitated – art, literature, culture



Life under the Satavahanas

- Satavahana traditions – princes – named after mothers
- Gautamiputra Satakarni – named after his mother – Gautami Balashri
- Balashri – powerful queen – donated land – Buddhist monks – imp. inscription carved in Nashik – showing her influence
- Another set – inscriptions – Naneghat caves – Pune – focuses – Satavahana widow queen – several Vedic rituals – including *Ashvamedha yajna*
- Inscriptions – mention Vedic gods – Indra, Chandra, Surya
- Also glimpse – queen's donations (*dana*) – land, cows, horses, elephants, silver coins, other items – priests, guests, workers, scholars, monks
- These inscriptions – Brahmi script – include numerals – evidence – modern numerals – originated in India
- Satavahanas – devout followers – Vasudeva (Krishna) – also patronized – other schools of thoughts – flourished – their rule
- Satavahana kings – granted – tax-free agriculture land – Vedic scholars, Jaina, Buddhist monks – helping them – studies, practices
- 3rd Cent. CE – Satavahana empire – fragmented – smaller kingdoms – several factors – most imp. – weak central control, gradual economic decline
- This – paves way – regional powers – assert, reassert – their dominance – establish new kingdom

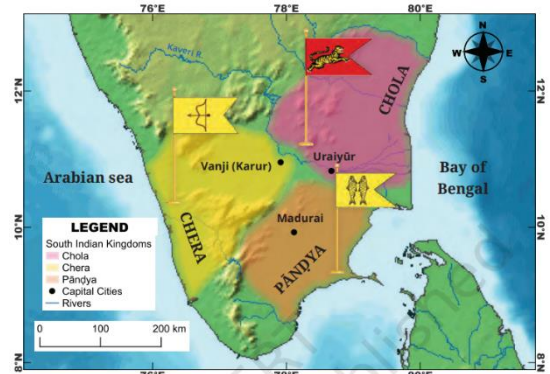


Coming of the Chedis

- Go back – Kalinga war – mentioned – previous chapter
- After decline of Maurya Empire – Kalinga – prominent power – kings – Chedi dynasty
- Kharavela – mani ruler – devoted follower – Jain teachings – sometimes called *bhikshu-raja* – monk-king – respected – all schools
- Bhubaneswar – Udayagiri-Khandagiri caves – made for Jain monks – intricate panels, statues, spacious rooms – carved – showcase skills – craftsmen
- Design, craftsmanship – notable example – rock-cut architecture
- One cave – Hathigumpha inscription – Brahmi script – record – Kharavela's accomplishments – military campaigns, benevolent work
- Kharavela – proudly announces – he created – council – ascetics, sages – hundred regions – accomplished – extraordinary virtues – respect – every sect – repair – temples
- Once again – ruler prides – extending – protection – all schools – fundamental part – Indian ethos

Kingdoms and Life in the South

- India's southern region – this period – 3rd – 2nd cent. BCE and 3rd cent. CE – 3 powerful kingdoms – Cheras, Cholas, Pandyas – competed – each other – control – South – also contribute – growth – trade, culture
- Ashoka's empire – stopped – south Indian kingdom – remained independent – height of Mauryan empire
- Kharavela – claims – defeated south Indian kings – BUT – location – unknown – did not invade – southern region
- This period – many poets – works – collectively – Sangam Literature – defined – entire era – known as – Sangam Age
- Sangam – derived – Sanskrit *sangha* – meaning – association – this context – assembly of poets
- Sangam literature – oldest – South India – several collections – poems – consulted by historians – investigate culture, society – that time
- Sangam poetry – express – personal emotions – love, societal values – heroism, generosity – great skill



The Cholas

- Sangams – refer – 3 crowned kings – Cholas, Cheras, Pandyas
- Cholas – powerful dynasty – ruled parts – south India – 3rd cent. BCE to 13th cent. CE
- Chola king – Karikala – defeated combined force – Cheras, Pandyas – established supremacy
- Karikala – many projects – benefit of people – among them – Kallanai (Grand Anicut) – complex water diversion sys. – located – geographical strategic pt. – downstream – Srirangam island
- This project – divert water – Kaveri River – central, southern parts – Kaveri Delta
- This enabled – more land – cultivation – earning name – rice bowl of South
- Restored several times – still in use – helps millions – Tamil Nadu – provide water – irrigation – support agriculture

Silappadikaram – the tale of anklet

- Famous epic – composed after Sangam – story of Kannagi – lived with husband Kovalan – Chola capital city – Puhar

- Kovalan – fell in love – dancer – lost his wealth – realized mistake – returned to Kannagi – forgave him
- They travelled to Madurai – Pandya kingdom – hope – rebuild lives
- Start new life – Kannagi gave Kovalan – anklet to sell – accused of theft – executed by Pandya King
- Kannagi proved – his innocence – revealing 2nd anklet – king – realized mistake – died of shock
- Kannagi – cursed Madurai – invoking God of fire – destroying the city
- Walked – further west – Chera kingdom – honoured as Goddess
- Kannagi – worshipped – till today – Tamil Nadu, Kerala
- *Silappadikaram* – poetry – centres – justice, ruler's dharma

The Cheras

- Also known – Keralaputra – sons of Kerala – Cheras – rule over – western parts – Tamil Nadu, Kerala – capital – Vanji – present-day Karur
- They played – essential role – shaping – cultural, economic history – encourage – Tamil literature
- Cheras – known for – trade connections – Roman empire, West Asia – exporting many goods
- Kingdom – hub – exports – spices, timber, ivory, pearls
- Chera king – issued – no. of coins

The Pandyas

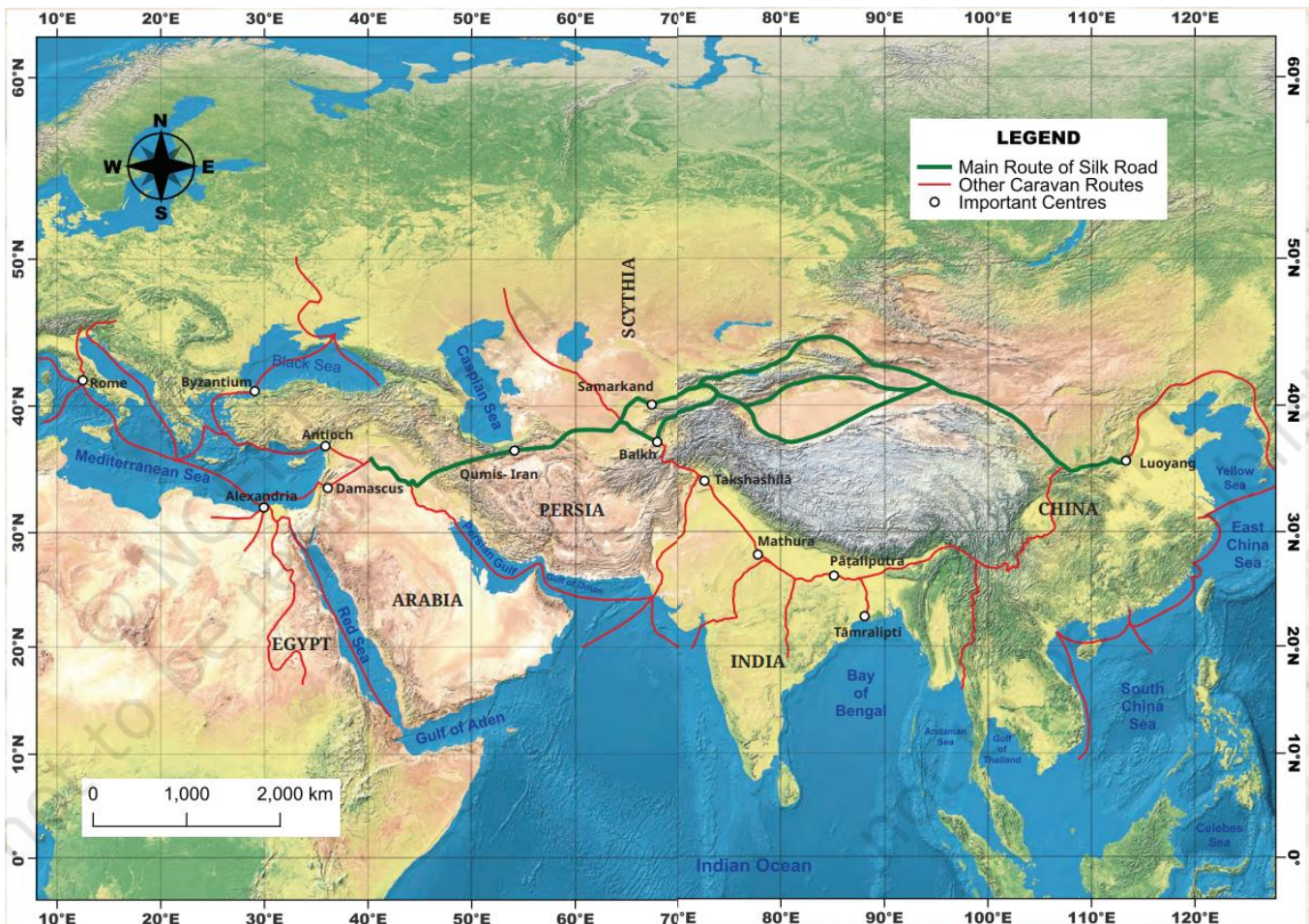
- Pandyas' rule – Tamil Nadu, surroundings – capital – present day Madurai – goes back – several cent. BCE
- Megasthenes – his work *Indika* – this kingdom – prosperous one – strong administration – active trade – distant powers – Greeks, Romans
- Pandyas – imp. naval power – later contributed – art, architecture, overall prosperity
- Pandyas – left inscriptions – kings asserted – great concern – subjects' welfare

Invasions of the Indo-Greeks

- After brief journey – South India – return to north – very different kind of development
- So far – few native dynasties – same period – arrival of invaders – entered – northwest frontier – took control – northwestern, northern, central regions
- 1st – examine – legacy of Alexander's campaign – Indus plains
- Retreat – conquered areas – left satraps behind – over time – regional rulers – independent domains – known as Indo-Greeks
- Decline of Mauryas – areas – northwestern regions – easy target – Indo-Greeks
- Arrived as conquerors – influenced by – rich local culture
- Cultural interactions – blend – Greek, Indian elements – governance, art, lang., daily life
- Heliodorus pillar – Vidisha (M.P.) – notable example – such connections – named after – Indo-Greek ambassador – his inscriptions – Vasudeva – god of gods
- Inscription – also states – 3 immortal steps – lead to heaven, self-restraint, charity, etc.
- Excavations – north India – archaeologists found – Indo-Greek coins – most info. – about rulers
- Those coins – made of – gold, silver, copper, nickel – king – one side – Greek deities – other side
- Some coins – Indian deities – Vasudeva-Krishna, Lakshmi
- Rule – Indo-Greeks – ended by – invasions – Indo-Scythians – Shakas

The Emergence of the Kushanas

- Kushanas – originally – Central India – entered India – 2nd cent. CE
- At peak – empire extended – Central Asia to northern India
- Their rule – period – cultural intermixing – profound Impact – history – Indian subcontinent
- When not busy – military campaigns – Kanishka encouraged – art, culture – lead – new artistic styles
- Famous headless statue – King Kanishka – most powerful ruler – Kushana dynasty
- Brahmi inscriptions – statue – reads – *maharaja rajadhiraja devaputra Kanishka* – great king, king of kings, son of God, Kanishka
- 1st coin – Kanishka – holding spear – King of Kings – other side – Buddha – inscription – BODDO – Greek script
- 2nd coin – one side – emperor – other side – Shiva, Nandi bull
- Kushanas – held control – significant sections – Silk Route – during this reign – trade grew – connect India – other parts – Asia, West
- Continue trend – Indo-Greek rulers – Kushana art, architecture – celebrated – fusion – Indian, Greek styles – exemplified by – Gandhara, Mathura schools of art
- Sculptures – feature – variety of deities – reflect – peaceful co-existence – various schools of thoughts
- This era – obs. –
 - Rise of representations of deities – Surya – Sun God – similar to humans
 - Increase – developments – religious art, temples, etc.
- Gandhara style – emerged – western region – blended – Greco-Roman elements – Indian features
- Most sculptures, artifacts – this tradition – intricate detail – grey-black schist stone
- Sculptors – produced – fine Buddha images – realistic anatomy, flowing robes



- Mathura style – distinct Indian style – primarily – red sandstone – less influence – Greco-Roman aesthetics
- This art form – depicts – Indian deities – Kubera, Lakshmi, Shiva, Buddha, *yakshas*, *yakshinis* – smooth modelling
- Political conflicts, power struggles – remarkable cultural exchange – lots of art, architecture – dominance – Indian themes
- This age – Sanskrit literature – flourished – Mahabharat, Ramayana